

004

'LAYERED, THEN STRIPPED

HAUTE



'SOUTHMARKETNORTH'



NOTE. FROM THE EDITOR IN CHIEF

There isn't much that brings me as much joy as the Haute team does. Whether it's through photography, writing, styling, organising, or modelling, everyone contributes something valuable. I am beyond grateful to interact with so many amazing creatives on a daily basis. Their distinct life philosophies colour their art with something impossible to replicate.

When I first joined the team, it was because I wanted to gain confidence in my writing abilities. Before, I had always been convinced that there was no new opinion I could possibly offer to the world. Haute welcomed me, and I finally got the chance to discover my voice and to let other people hear it. This experience inspired the first word in our yearly theme: "layered". Haute made me

find out that no perspective is ever superfluous: every voice is nuanced. The second half of the theme ("and then, stripped") was decided alongside our creative director Jennie. She reminded me of the responsibility (and possibility) that we have, as an independent, student-led magazine, to look underneath the surface, and to strip the layers that cover and censor reality.

Haute 004 explores the dual nature of the layer. In some cases, a layer adds dimension and nuance: it must be preserved. In other cases, it covers and hides: it must be stripped.

-- MARIA DE FEO



A.

UNDERGROUND /
SUBWAY SONNET (SORT
OF)

Love left me as dirty as the
place I found it
and granted me reason, too
little too late.

Stuck in the dressing room,
trying to fit

into stained dresses made
of dead stock knits.

Oh, God forbid I believe in
fate!

Underground, my love
forever shall sit.

- BAILEY ANDREA

I stand in the shower, my tiny
shower shared between five
girls in a Scottish flat.
The room is small, quickly
filling with steam.
The dial is turned all the
way. 48 degrees Celcius.
Scorching.
I can't breathe when I get out.
But I am only focused on
finding fresh air. And lotion.
My skin is pink and raw,
itching for moisture.
But I feel clean. Today's shell
down the drain.
My outer self peeling off
for the night, with my sanity
along with it.
In my room, it's just me. It's
always just been me. Wish I
thought it was only because
I'm an only child. But I know I
can't blame it on that.
I don't know how to be
someone else, no matter
how much I wish.
Countless upon countless
nights I've sat in my room.
The walls act as a blockade
for my scrawny soul,
reflecting too much.
My room is filled to the brim.
Photos, stuff, clothing.

All my things I've gotten from
the world. All the memories
I've made outside.
But when I lay in my bed,
sheets pulled up to my chin,
it's just me.
I lie in the darkness, and
there is no outer me.
I am stripped down to my
soul. My inner workings,
always working too hard.
I don't think my mind and my
active body have ever been
on the same page.
Maybe when you see me on
the street. Maybe it looks like
it then.
But I lay awake, it is just my
flimsy thoughts, striving for
more.
Craving more. Wanting more.
Always.
Why aren't I more like my
layers I put on to go outside?
Why am I like myself?
It's as if my inner workings
are just made of thought
after thought.
I lay in the dark, wishing for
the steam. To only focus on
one thing.

- RACHEL HAMBLY

ST. ANDREWS IS A VIDEO GAME

Are you an enthusiastic member of St. Andrews' Clay Pigeon Shooting Society? A keen participant in the Kate Kennedy Club? Perhaps the start to an ideal Friday night pictures you having a drink or two at the Central.

If you gave me a short rundown of your interests, I could guess with near-accuracy how you curate your wardrobe in St. Andrews. It's a universal phenomenon: whoever you are, your taste in clothing is more or less representative of your daily routine. But in St. Andrews, where keen golfers are also techno-music enthusiasts and ArtSoc committee members are seen at Caledonian Society balls, this theme is not only amplified but also geared towards specific activities. The possibilities for different looks are endless; so much so that it's almost like it becomes a video game. As social media feeds and Market Street alike become increasingly overwhelmed i

with commercial products designed to promote our personal style – I think it's time to ask ourselves whether all of this is necessary. The more I feel myself getting submerged in the video game of collecting St Andrews closet staples, the more I lose my sense of what's true to my personal taste, not just in clothes. The time I devote to focusing on my personal "avatar" far outweighs the time I spend on my actual interests. Fashion is one of them, as it is for many of us. However, as society's interest in merchandise swings from one end of the pendulum to the other, I, among plenty of others, can't help but fall into the endless video game where coveted consumer products win you points that count towards the final objective: gaining social status. The problem is, like all video games wanting to keep their players playing, does that final end goal even exist? And if it does, how is it obtainable, and who dictates that?

-- CLEMENTINE WILSON

CUT PIECE

(top layer)

I speak from the surface first,
where language is still intact:
where words are not cursed
and mean what they should
I begin with the skin I show to
others:

my superficial cover on which I
am writing

I slowly start to dress myself in
words,

stitching them together - com-
pound-words - until they fit me

(German can combine nouns
almost infinitely: Wortschatzverlust,

English pulls them apart -
vocabulary loss)

underwear, makeup, overcoat -
isn't that quite fitting?

following the stitches and the
seam,

I cut apart what I am supposed
to be

(base layer)

in German we say we have fur
on our tongue when something
tastes off

mine feels thick and too warm

with foreign syllables. I do not
yet know how to speak
on bare skin, I bear the weight
of a thousand layers pressing
onto me

I am a seamstress, stressing
over misplaced stress
rarely punctual - punctuation
punctures the page...

I am hemming the edges of
foreign sounds

my consonants rough, never
soft, threads caught on
vowels

feeling off when I speak -
sentences cut back at me

I slip - slipping beneath
endless slip dresses,

hiding layered meaning
hidden in ruffles,

revealing bottomless moth
holes

I speak (or try to speak) (or try)
(or) ()

stripped of clothes and
words, I become a stripper

remove meaning: I re-tailor
remove detail: I remain

this is the last layer; this is the
end

(even the end is a layer)

-- Lena Sophie Eckgold

ANODE TO MATERIALITY

The cold grasp of metal
hands and fabric fingers.
Tinkling links and fairy drops.

A knitted constrictor and
woven crown.

Pillows of feathers
connected by teeth of
plastic.

Blue fingers from deep
pockets and dye packets.
Light-wash, dark-wash, do-
not-wash.

Drape, pin, button, clasp.
Wear, feel, style, consume.

More.

— Mathilda Gatsby

BABUSHKA'S BOP

Slavic style. For the Western, these words can summon an assortment of connotations almost as vast as the former Soviet Union itself. Some may envision sprawling Khrushchevky, Soviet buildings in washes of stoney grey oppressed by sheets of snow. For some technicolor peasants might frolic with bears across lacquered boxes to the sound of balalaikas played by men imbibed with vodka. Decadence, beauty, mysticism, the “Slavic soul”.

On the 14th of October, the D.J. collective Tempo, many members of which are from Eastern Europe, hosted a “Babushka” rave. The graphics were overtly Soviet, using black, red, and white graphics. On the collective’s Instagram, a propagandistic post read,

“Got kicked out of Babushka for not wearing enough layers – bouncer said, “Come back when you look disappointed in your grandchildren.”

Ravers were encouraged to dress according to the eastern European theme, with a costume contest as enticement. The majority sported the quintessential Babushka kerchiefs. Headscarves in Eastern Europe, however, are more than accessories, but are part of the many cultural layers relating to the devotion, history, and fellowship of women. Pious Orthodox and Catholic women often cover their hair, following Paul’s biblical teachings. In the Soviet context, veiling was co-opted, signaling devotion to communism and temple of the factory instead of God. Ukrainian immigrants to America shared the tradition with the Cree, who sport fuska to this day. Perhaps unintentionally, “Babushka” presented an opportunity for young women to engage the headscarf’s broader role as an icon of identity, femininity, and Slavic style

-- Elizabeth Hambly



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-- LAUREL LAZZARESCHI

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